

Board 1

North Deals

None Vul

♠ Q J 9 5 3
♥ K 4 3
♦ K 8 2
♣ 10 4

♠ A 7 4

♥ A 8 5 2

♦ Q 10 9 4

♣ A K

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ K 10 6

♥ J 10 7 6

♦ A 6 5

♣ Q 7 5

♠ 8 2

♥ Q 9

♦ J 7 3

♣ J 9 8 6 3 2

West

North

East

South

1NT

Pass

2♠

Pass

3♣

All Pass

3♣ by North

The 2♠ bid is used as a transfer to 3♣.

If you don't use this in your system, just consider this hand; you might decide to incorporate it. So you bid 3♣ and everybody passes.

North plays 3♣. East leads the ♥J.

You play dummy's ♥Q hopefully, but West plays the ♥K.

Loser List: ♠ = 1 : ♥ = 1 : ♦ = 2 : ♣ = 1 :: Total = 5

That is one loser too many. The ♣Q MIGHT drop . . . but she won't. There are no finesse positions. So you are going to have to establish a winner somewhere to discard dummy's small ♠.

Do you see it? The ♥8. Take the ♥A. Then play your ♣ A K. As predicted, the ♣Q doesn't fall. Then play a small ♥ to dummy's ♥9. Of course East will take the ♥10, but now your ♥8 is high.

As soon as you get the lead you play the ♥8 and discard dummy's ♠2.

We know, you didn't really play the ♥Q on the first trick in the hope that East had underled the ♥K (although he certainly might have done so).

The real reason for covering was so you could establish the ♥8 by force.

Suppose you had not played the ♥Q to trick one. West would have withheld the ♥K and you'd have had to take your ♥A. Later West would have taken dummy's ♥Q with his ♥K, then played a small ♥ through your ♥8 to East's ♥10 7.

Board 3

East Deals

E-W Vul

♠ A K J 7 3

♥ 8 4 3

♦ A 5 4

♣ K 9

♠ 2

♥ J 10 9

♦ J 8 6 3

♣ 8 7 5 4 2

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ Q 10 8 5

♥ A Q 7

♦ K Q 9 2

♣ A 6

♠ 9 6 4

♥ K 6 5 2

♦ 10 7

♣ Q J 10 3

West

North

East

South

2♥

Pass

1NT

3♠

Pass

Pass

6♠

All Pass

6♠ by East

Loser List: ♠ = 0 : ♥ = 2 : ♦ = 0 : ♣ = 0 :: Total = 2

There are two obvious possibilities for avoiding the ♥ loser. You could finesse North for the ♥K; this is a 50% chance. The ♦s could split 3-3; this is a 36% chance.

In fact, your chances are better than either of those percentages because you can try the ♦s first, and if they **DON'T** split you can then try the ♥ finesse.

Pull trumps; South shows up with 3 trumps. Play the ♦K, then a small ♦ to dummy's ♦A. On this trick South follows with the ♦10.

Your contract just became a sure thing! Play the ♣K to strip both your hands of ♣s. Lead dummy's last ♦, and when North plays low, finesse the ♦9. If the finesse wins, discard a ♥ from dummy on your good ♦. But if the finesse loses to South's ♦J, he will be endplayed and have to lead a ♥ into your ♥A Q or give you a ruff/sluff with a ♣. And on top of that your fourth ♦ will be good.

In this actual Deal your ♦ finesse worked which gave you 4 ♦ tricks.

But imagine that the ♦J is transposed to the South hand. He wins that ♦ trick but must give you the contract with his return.

You could either use a transfer or you could jump to 3♠. You decide on the transfer and bid 2♥. Partner jumps to 3♠!

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The 3♠ bid is a "Super-accept", showing a maximum 1NT opener, 4 ♠s and a doubleton. In other words, partner's hand has revalued to 18 points. So you bid 6♠ (or you could ask for Aces instead).

The contract would be 6♠ played by West.

East plays 6♠. South leads the ♣Q, North follows with the ♣2.

You win the first trick with the ♣A in your hand.